Questions, conflicts, and influence

HIST 212 · Final project workshop · Question and evidence due November 3

Choose one question. Use the figures and texts below to turn it into a claim you can test.

Question bank

Politics

Who won the Great Debate, and why?

Why wasn't there another Qin - or was there?

War

Why did Mozi's arguments fail to stop conquest?

Could a Buddhist serve a king at war?

Culture

Why aren't the losers always erased?

Which ancient ideas still live on today?

Economics

Salt and Iron: who should control the economy?

Would people be better off if rulers did less?

Define "winning": royal support, laws, schools, family practices, or later readers. These can produce different winners.

Key figures · conflicts & influence

Ru / Confucian traditions · Kongzi → Zhu Xi

How does a teaching gain power through education and family life?

Fa / statecraft · Shang Yang · Han Feizi

Could Qin fall while its methods of rule survived?

Mo / Mohist arguments · Mozi

Can an argument outlive the movement that promoted it?

Dao / Daoist traditions · Laozi · Zhuangzi

Must an idea control the state to influence how people live?

Fo / Buddhist traditions · Huiyuan · Wŏn'gwang

Why might a ruler support a religion that limits royal authority?

Key texts · start with a pair

Analects 2.3; Zhu Xi's academy rules (SCT 743). Compare moral training and its institutions.

Han Feizi, "Two Handles," ch. 7; Li Si's memorials (SCT 207–212). Identify tools of state power.

Mozi 17; Salt and Iron (CC 61). Compare objections to aggression with the defense of military spending.

Laozi 37; Taika edicts (SJT 77–79). Contrast restraint with an active program of government.

Huiyuan (SCT 427–429); Wŏn'gwang (SKT 45–46). Compare monks' obligations to rulers.

Finish the November 3 submission · about one page

1. Choose and focus. Name a conflict, place, and period. Write your historical question.

2. Answer provisionally. Give a tentative answer in one or two sentences.

3. Explain two passages. Quote each briefly; cite its source and page/section. Identify the speaker and situation. Explain how its words support or challenge your answer.

Submit in Canvas: Question and evidence. Salt and Iron counts as one primary source.

Final project: two periods, three East Asian societies, four primary sources. To connect past and present, trace transmission or revival; resemblance alone does not prove inheritance.